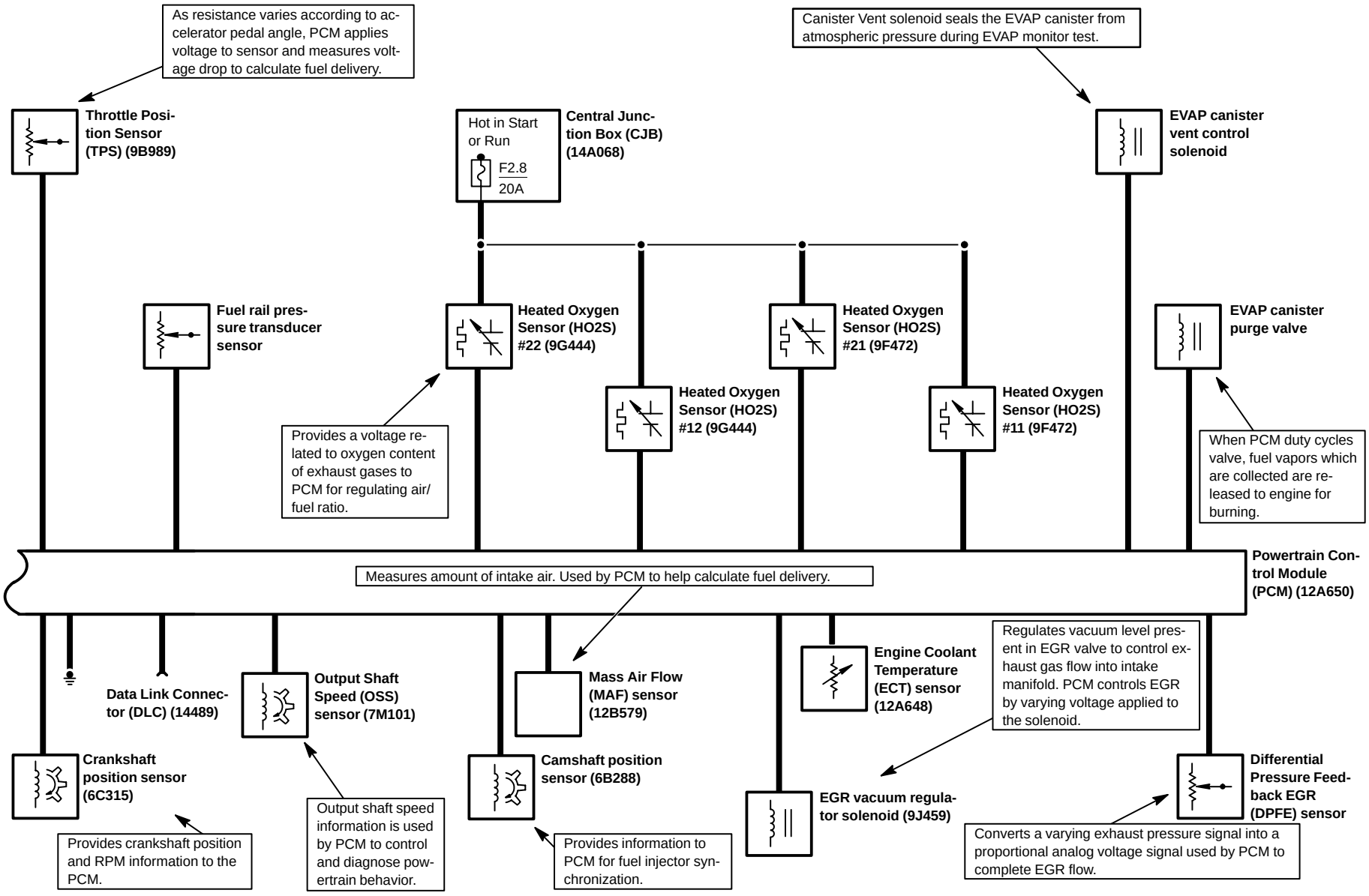Cobra, System overview